



UNIVERSITY OF
BATH

Faculty of Science

Department of Computer Science

MSc in Artificial Intelligence

Course Handbook

4 May 2026 start



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About this handbook

This Handbook is intended for all students commencing the Online MSc Artificial Intelligence on 4 May 2026, 2025/6 academic year.

Your handbook for commencing on 4 May 2026 comprises the following three sections

1. University information
2. Department information
3. Your Course information

Your handbook signposts you to important services and information that you should be aware of whilst studying here at Bath. Please take your time to familiarise yourself with the University's expectations of you as a student, how the University will support you, and important information about your studies.

This document contains links to the standard University policies and procedures. It also includes Department/Course information, where any non-standard practice and specific details are explained.

When you registered with the University you agreed to access and read this handbook. **You are expected to familiarise yourself with the contents.**

Please note, direct links have been provided where possible. These links are embedded in the section title or part of the applicable text for ease.

Status

Please note that the contents of this Handbook are accurate at the time of publication (8 April 2026), but information may sometimes be subject to change after this Handbook has been issued. You will be informed of any changes and issued with a revised version, if there are any material changes to the information in this handbook.

Section 1 - University Information

The University's expectation of students

Registering with the University

You must register at the specified time, normally **at the start of every academic year** to re-confirm your status as a student of the University, check that the details we hold about you are correct and to allow you to update your semester and home address as necessary. Being registered allows you to use University facilities, such as email, the VLE and the Library. We will normally email you every September to remind you to re-register.

University Regulations for Students

All students are subject to the University's Regulations for Students. The Regulations contain rules and other important information about being a student at the University of Bath, including:

- payment of fees
- student conduct and discipline
- health, wellbeing and support for study
- academic appeals
- attendance
- progress in your studies and the award of your degree (assessment regulations)

They also form part of the formal contract between you and the University. Please read them carefully as they contain important information.

Students' Union Membership

All students registered with the University are automatically given membership of the Students' Union; however, you have the right not to be a member. Information on opting out of this membership, and the Code of Practice for the Students' Union, are available online.

Attendance

It is a [University Regulation \(3.1\)](#) that you participate regularly in the learning activities and make academic progress, as required by your course. If circumstances are such that you are not able to do so, then please contact your SSC to discuss your situation and agree an appropriate course of action.

Study breaks

If you are considering taking a study break, suspending your studies, transferring to another course, or withdrawing from your course, please discuss your situation with your SSC in the first instance. They will be able to advise you on the most appropriate form of action. You can find out more in your [Programme Hub](#).

Accessing your university email

You will need to use your username and password to access your University email account. Your username also forms your email address (username@bath.ac.uk).

The University will often communicate with you about a range of important matters requiring action from you via your university email account. **It is a requirement ([Regulation 1.3](#)) that you access your University email account regularly, even if you are on a study break or in suspense.** You must ensure that your university email account can receive incoming mail and that you read your email regularly.

Once you graduate or withdraw from your course, you will receive an email stating exactly when your account will be closed. The email will give at least 30 days' notice.

Your Student Record

You are expected to make sure the University holds your correct, up-to-date, personal, and academic details. You will also be prompted to check and update these as necessary during the registration process. You can view information we hold about you and your studies in the central student record system known as SAMIS. You can use SAMIS to update and change:

- your address
- your telephone/mobile number(s)
- your personal email address
- any data we hold about your identity including name, gender, title, and the pronouns you use
- your trusted contact details

You can also use SAMIS to request and generate documents such as a transcript and a self-service proof of student status letter once you have registered. The transcript facility may sometimes be unavailable in SAMIS because it is switched off when results are being prepared for Boards of Examiners. If you are unable to view your results in SAMIS you may contact your Student Support Coordinator for assistance.

Change in academic circumstances

If you are considering suspending your studies, transferring from one course to another, or withdrawing from your course, please discuss your situation with your Student Support Coordinator in the first instance. You can find out more in your [Programme Hub](#).

We review and update our courses periodically. If you choose to suspend your studies and re-join your course in the following year, you may experience some changes to the content and structure of the course.

Adjustments to your learning

If you feel you need adjustments to be made to your learning due to a long term health condition, disability, or specific learning difficulty (SpLD) you can speak to your Academic Advisor or Director of Studies, or [contact the Disability Service](#).

Suspending your studies

If you need to take a formal break from your studies, you can apply to suspend for personal reasons, usually for up to 12 months. Suspension may also be required by the University for academic or other reasons. During this time, you won't be expected to engage with your course.

Dignity and Respect

The University is fully committed to fostering a working and learning environment that promotes inclusion, equality, diversity and accessibility. We believe in treating every individual with dignity and respect. We value difference, celebrate diversity, and strive to build a community founded on kindness, care, and empathy. Behaviours that undermine a person's dignity, wellbeing, or sense of belonging have no place in our community. The University will take any allegation of unacceptable behaviour extremely seriously.

Harassment and sexual misconduct

We're committed to a working and learning environment which is supportive and free from discrimination, harassment, bullying and victimisation.

Student Conduct

The University has clear expectations of the behaviour of its students and will take disciplinary action to address inappropriate behaviour or 'misconduct' which doesn't meet these.

What you can expect from the university to support you

Services to support you during your time at university

The Library

The University Library provides a wide range of resources to support you in your studies, including print and electronic books and journals and a large range of specialist databases for every subject.

The Skills Centre

The Skills Centre provides academic, mathematics, language and digital skills support and enhancement, for your studies and future employment.

Student Support

Find support and guidance including:

- [mental health](#) and wellbeing support
- Disability Service
- student money advice
- international student advice

The Students' Union Advice and Support Service

The Students' Union provides advice and support for all aspects of student life, including academic matters, housing, and personal issues. Information is available online and through professional advisors, who can offer confidential, independent, and non-judgmental information, advice, and support.

Careers Service

The University Careers Service can guide and advise you through the career planning process, whatever your career aspirations and experience to date. The Careers Service can help you navigate various recruitment and selection processes, and work with you to refine your CV and hone your interview technique. We also have a small team of professionally trained careers consultants who offer careers advice and guidance, enabling you to take that important next step, whether that's a career pivot or advancing in your current role.

You will also find the Careers Service is a fantastic source for job vacancies, but it is worth noting that most of these are pitched at a graduate population with limited professional experience. If you are mid-career or looking to start afresh, you may need to consider other avenues, but our careers professionals will help direct you to useful portals and job search website.

For more information or to book an appointment look at the [Resources and Support](#) section on your Programme Hub.

The Careers Service is open throughout the year. To access appointments, book events and search live vacancies log in to [MyFuture Careers Portal](#) You can also download a range of careers guides to help you with CV writing, career options, job search as an experienced hire, networking and much more.

Further information

Get in touch: careers@bath.ac.uk

Subscribe to the [Bath Careers blog](#),

Follow on @CareersatBath, Facebook (search for BathUniCareers) or Instagram: [Instagram](#)

University processes and policies to support you during your time at university

Dealing with a problem involving the University

The University is committed to providing an environment within which you are encouraged to raise any matters of concern in an informal manner as soon as they arise.

Support and report tool

You can report discrimination, sexual misconduct, harassment, bullying or any unwanted behaviour by using this tool. You can report anonymously or get support from an adviser.

Complaints

If you need to make a complaint the policy and procedures in place to deal with it are designed to ensure that your complaint will be dealt with in good faith and that you will not be penalised for complaining.

The University recognises that making a complaint can be stressful. You are therefore advised to seek advice and support before making a complaint, from [Student Support](#), or from the [Students' Union Advice and Support Centre](#), whose advice is independent of the University.

Appealing against a decision of the University

You are entitled to appeal the outcome of decisions the University takes during your studies. Independent advice about appeals is offered by the Students' Union Advice and Support Centre. Decisions that you can appeal against include:

- a Board of Studies decision about academic outcomes such as your marks, your award decision or classification, (known as an Academic Appeal).
- student disciplinary outcome
- assessment offence outcome
- expulsion from the University

Sustainability at Bath

Would you like to save money, build your community, improve health and wellbeing and help the planet? Find out how you can get involved with sustainability action at the University of Bath where we take a whole-institution approach that includes:

- researching solutions to tackle climate change and sustainability challenges
- providing education to empower you to lead change now and when you graduate
- reducing the environmental footprint of the University
- forging partnerships to bring wider transformation for a sustainable future for people and the planet

Data Protection

The University adheres to Data Protection legislation, including GDPR.

Support, equalities, diversity and inclusion

The following set out the support, advice, and resources available:

- [Assistive Technology](#)
- [students with disabilities, long-term illness, and specific learning difficulties](#)
- [pregnancy and maternity](#)

Important information about your studies

Learning and Teaching

The University has mechanisms in place to assure the quality and standard of your course. You can find further information on the policies and procedures described below in the [Quality Assurance Code of Practice](#).

How your course is reviewed and monitored

The University monitors and reviews your course through ongoing examination of key indicators, for example, student feedback, course data and External Examiner reports.

Student representation

The University's [mechanisms for student representation](#) are designed to enable you to engage with quality management processes and to be an active partner in its aim to continually improve the learning and teaching experience. The **main ways in which your feedback will be sought** will be through:

- Staff/Student Liaison Committees (SSLCs)
- surveys and evaluations
- the Students' Union

You can find more information in your [Student Engagement Hub](#).

Course and unit changes

All [course and unit changes](#) are managed through formal University processes. This is to ensure that changes are academically appropriate, properly supported and are made in a way that safeguards the interests of students. Changes can be made for a number of reasons, for example, they could be aimed at enhancing your learning experience, following student feedback, or in response to accrediting body requirements. **You will be consulted**

about any proposed changes, either via your Staff/Student Liaison Committee or directly, depending on the nature of the change.

Additional course-related costs

Please be aware that some courses will have additional course related costs, such as software, equipment, materials etc.

Assessment processes

The QA Code of Practice covers principles and procedures relating to:

- assessment deadlines, extensions, late submission, and penalties (See your [programme hub](#) for more specific details on this)
- assessment design and setting
- marking, moderation, and feedback
- Boards of Examiners, the role of the External Examiner and how your results are considered.

Academic Registry have provided a [summary of assessment guidance for students](#).

Assessment regulations

Assessment Regulations set out the rules for your course including how the University governs your outcomes, progression requirements and what happens if you fail, award eligibility and how your classification is calculated. The assessment regulations should be read in conjunction with your course specification information in this document which sets out key information about your course. **You are expected to familiarise yourself with these documents.**

[You can find guidance on assessment arrangements on our website.](#)

If you have any questions about the assessment regulations or guidance, please contact your [Director of Studies](#) in the first instance.

Academic Integrity

The University's principles regarding academic integrity and its expectations of students are outlined in [Student Regulations 15](#). Beyond this the University has a [wide range of resources](#) available to you to help you understand the importance of academic integrity and how you can enhance your academic writing and practice.

You will be unable to progress beyond the next progression point in your studies until you pass the University's Academic Integrity Test. The test has a pass mark of 85% but you can take the test as many times as you need to. It is expected that all students will undertake the training and complete the test within a short time after entry.

Please note some of your data is retained when you submit your assessment to the [Plagiarism Detective Service](#).

Academic Misconduct

Academic misconduct is described as 'the use of unfair means in any examination or assessment procedure'. Any student who is found to have used unfair means and therefore committed an assessment offence will be penalised. Examples of different types of potential offence are listed in [Student Regulations 19](#). Penalties for offences depend upon the severity but may include failure of the assessment, unit, or part of a degree. You are expected to familiarise yourself with the information available about Academic Misconduct.

If you are suspected of an assessment offence, the [Students' Union's advice](#) service is available to support you. You have the right to appeal against the outcome of the investigation.

Individual mitigating circumstances (IMCs)

The University acknowledges that you may experience circumstances that disrupt any assessment attempt or performance. Submitting an IMC claim allows you to report any conditions which prevented you from taking assessments or significantly impaired your performance. If accepted, an IMC recognises that your assessment was affected.

You are expected to familiarise yourself with the information available about IMCs including the process for submission, the evidence requirements, how claims are considered and what can (and cannot) happen if a claim is accepted as valid.

Please note: If there are valid circumstances preventing you from meeting a coursework deadline, **requesting an extension** would be the right course of action if failure to do so would be likely to lead to the submission of a valid IMC claim after the coursework deadline. **If you find that your circumstances are such that you are struggling to complete a graded assessment on time, you can apply for an extension to your submission deadline.** See [section Requesting an Extension](#) for more information.

Section 2 - Department information

Welcome

Welcome to the University of Bath!

Your course is delivered by the Department of Computer Science within the [Faculty of Science](#).

Introduction to the Department

The Faculty of Science

The Faculty of Science is one of three Faculties and one School in the University

The Faculty comprises six [departments](#):

Life Sciences, Chemistry, Computer Science, Mathematical Sciences, Natural Sciences and Physics.

The Department of Computer Science



Welcome to the Department of Computer Science. We hope that you will have an enjoyable and worthwhile time with us. Please take some time to read through this handbook and familiarise yourself with the contents.

In this handbook we highlight and summarise key information that most students need to know. It will often point to other information sources, which contain more detail for those who need it.

Dr Hongping Cai, Director of Studies

Key Contacts/Your Student Support team

You have a team of people who will support you through your course. Their roles and how to contact them can be found in the Your Support Network section of your Programme Hub.

External Examiners

External Examiners are appointed for a course or set of courses and are important in assuring academic quality and standards. Please note that it is not appropriate for students to contact an External Examiner directly. If you have any queries or concerns, please contact your Director of Studies in the first instance.

[External Examiner for Academic Year 2025/26:](#)

Dr Masoumeh Mansouri, University of Birmingham

Learning and Teaching Delivery

Learning resources: your Online Environment

Your course of study is delivered in an online learning environment called Engage.

Engage is a versatile and immersive online platform that will enable you to enjoy a varied learning experience. As you progress through your study units, you will be required to complete tasks in a wide variety of formats. These could include:

- Discussion forums
- Group and individual presentations
- Audiovisual recordings
- ePortfolio tasks
- Interactive tasks

Unit and Course Information

You will find information about your course units in your Programme Hub. Please note that the content of the course descriptions are correct at the time of production of this Handbook and that courses and units may be subject to reasonable change (see section: [appendix 1](#)).

Unit delivery schedule

The start dates for your units are available in your Programme Hub. For information on taking a study break and formal suspension see section on [changes in circumstances](#).

Finance and Fees

Information about unit fees, including the larger dissertation fee, terms and conditions, including fee refunds, and how to pay for your units can be found in the Paying for your Unit section of your Programme Hub

Postgraduate Loan

If you have a UK fee status you may be eligible to apply for a postgraduate loan from the UK government. Please note however, if you are in receipt of a postgraduate loan, you must study at a pace to complete the course within a maximum period of 3 years to remain eligible for loan funding. For further advice contact your SSC in the first instance.

Assessment

Assessment Regulations

The University's **New Framework for Assessment: Assessment Regulations – Postgraduate Online Courses ('NFAAR-PGOLC')** specifies the rules governing students' progression on their course as well as for the making of awards. The rules cover all areas of assessment, including supplementary assessment.

Your course is covered by the NFAAR-PGOLC, so your work will be assessed according to its rules.

If at any time you are in doubt about how NFAAR-PGOLC provisions apply to your work, please consult your Director of Studies.

This section highlights areas of the University's assessment framework for the type of course you are undertaking. It explains the regulations that govern your assessment and outlines how the University makes decisions concerning your progression through your course and award. Complete information is available in the NFAAR-PGOLC document.

Your course and how you are assessed

The following points will help you to understand how the assessment rules relate to your specific programme, such as pass marks, averaging of marks and dealing with any failures:

Your programme is a single-stage programme, so your eligibility for the award you seek will only be judged at the end of the programme.

Your programme has just one stage comprising both the units that constitute the Taught Stage(s) Credits and the Dissertation/Project type unit(s). The status of the different units is indicated in the table showing the structure of your programme ([appendix 1](#)).

Should you fail to qualify for the award of the degree of Master, you may be considered for the award of a related Postgraduate Diploma or Postgraduate Certificate (subject to your having met the requirements for one of those awards).

Your study and assessment will be governed by some general rules that apply to all NFAAR- PGOLC framework courses:

- You must pass all of the units you have agreed to undertake within the maximum period of study in order to gain the award you seek.

- The normal unit pass mark is 40%.
- If you fail to meet the requirements of a unit's assessment at the first attempt, you will be permitted to undertake supplementary assessment.
- If, at any point, you have no more than 20 CATS credits' worth of failed units awaiting supplementary assessment you may proceed to the study of further units but will be required to take supplementary assessment in each failed unit.
- If, at any point, you have more than 20 credits' worth of failed units awaiting supplementary assessment, you will be required to take supplementary assessment in each failed unit, with a view then to qualifying to proceed to the study of further units.
- If you fail units at both main and supplementary assessment attempts you will, within the maximum period of study as set in the learning contract, be allowed to retake those units. Such units will not count as failed units awaiting supplementary assessment.

Supplementary assessment

'Supplementary assessment' is the term normally used for an opportunity given to a student to retrieve failure

Through supplementary assessment, students will normally have the opportunity to gain credit for units they successfully passed and to have the mark gained reported to them for feedback purposes, but a maximum mark of 40% will be awarded and used in the Overall Programme Average, the Taught Stage(s) Average, and any award calculation.

Calculating your degree outcome

A Board of Examiners will decide at appropriate points whether you are continuing to meet the requirements for the programme and/or whether you have met all the requirements for your target award or any alternative that might be available. The outcomes will depend on both your performance in individual units and your overall performance. Generally, if you pass each of your units, you will progress and, in due course, be recommended for an award.

As a course leading to a Master degree, units are of the 'Taught type' (or are part of a taught phase of the course) and are of the 'Dissertation/Project type' (or are part of a Dissertation/Project phase of the course): these unit- types become important in determining whether a Master award can be made with merit or with distinction.

Your unit results are combined as follows to make overall assessment/award decisions:

- The Taught Stage(s) Average (TSA) will be calculated by taking the credit-weighted average of marks for all units required to contribute to the taught stage(s), or by taking the credit-weighted average of marks for all units defined as of 'Taught type' required to contribute to the programme.
- The Dissertation/Project Average (DPA) will be calculated by taking the credit-weighted average of marks for the unit(s) required to contribute to the Dissertation/Project stage(s), or by taking the credit-weighted average of marks for the unit(s) defined as of 'Dissertation/Project type' required to contribute to the programme.
- The Overall Programme Average (OPA) will be calculated by taking the credit-weighted average of marks for all units required to contribute to the programme.

The criteria for making awards with distinction or with merit are described in the relevant NFAAR-PGOLC rules (paras 37a-c)

The table in the Course Structure section (see [appendix 1](#)) shows the structure of your course. If there are *compulsory units*, (i.e. those units in a course which must be taken by every student registered on the course), and *optional units* (i.e. those units you may choose from a range of options), these are labelled accordingly ('C' and 'O' respectively). Please also see the [appendix 1](#) section of this handbook for further information.

Please note that the content of the course description in the table is correct at the time of production of this Handbook and that courses and units may be subject to reasonable change (see section: Unit and Course Changes). Current unit descriptions are available via the [Programme Hub](#).

Exit awards

If you leave the University early, without completing your course, you may be eligible for an exit award. You will find information on these awards in the [Course Structure](#) section.

Graded Assessments

Assignment briefs

You will normally receive the following information about an assessment task:

- *its weighting in calculating the mark for the unit*
- *the assessment criteria, and any grade criteria relevant to the subject*
- *the timing, nature, and extent of feedback you can expect and whether this is to be accompanied by the return of assessed work*
- *the requirements of the assessment task(s)*
- *the word limit/range, and the penalty for non-compliance. If a penalty policy is not stated in writing the University default policy will apply*
- *any special presentation or referencing preferences/requirements*
- *the date for submission of the work*
- *the dates when any further detailed information about the individual task(s) will be communicated and how they will be communicated*
- *for graded tests, information on the conditions under which the test will be conducted (e.g., open-book) or other specific requirements*
- *whether the work is to be submitted anonymously*
- *any specific requirements of professional, regulatory, or statutory bodies*

Word Counts

Coursework tasks will normally have a word limit or word range. This, and the penalty for not adhering to this, will be confirmed when you receive an assignment. If a penalty policy is not stated in writing the University default policy will apply. Markers may stop reading/marking your work at the point it exceeds the word/page limit.

You will find information on word counts in the [Assignments and Grades](#) section of your Programme Hub.

You should check with your Unit tutor or DoS if you have questions about word counts and penalties.

Deadlines

To ensure fairness to all students, you will be expected to hand in all assessed coursework and dissertations/projects by a specified date and time, and there are penalties for submitting work after the specified deadline. The deadline for each graded assessment will be specified in each unit in Engage on the relevant assignment page.

If you are experiencing difficulties completing work on time, please seek help before the deadline.

Requesting an Extension

If you find you are facing circumstances that are preventing you from submitting on time you can request an extension to your deadline before the work is due. Short extensions are often granted but occasionally there may be better measures to support you depending on your individual circumstances and the type of assessment. You will need to give a brief explanation of how your circumstances are impacting on your ability to complete on time. Extension requests require evidence to confirm what has happened and when.

Talk to your Student Support Coordinator (onlinestudentsupport@bath.ac.uk) as soon as possible if you become concerned about your workload and meeting deadlines. Your SSC will discuss your options with you.

Depending on the length of extension you require, it may be better for you to discuss with your SSC options for taking a Study Break or Suspension. This is to help you avoid the knock-on effect into the next unit.

For full information on extensions and how to request them please see the Extensions and Study Breaks section in the [Programme Hub](#).

Late submission of graded assessments

To ensure fairness to all students, you will be expected to submit all graded assessments and your dissertation/project by a specified date and time, and there are penalties for submitting work after the specified deadline. **If you are experiencing difficulties completing work on time, please seek help before the deadline.**

For full information on penalties for missing a submission deadline - either the original deadline or an extended deadline - please see the Extensions and Study Breaks section in the [Programme Hub](#).

Marking and feedback

We have processes in place to ensure that assessment is conducted and marked in a fair and rigorous manner which upholds the academic standards of the University. You can find further information [on such processes, and their purpose, on our website](#). During your course, you will receive feedback on assessed work. Feedback on assessments may take different forms, depending on your subject and the type of assessment.

You will find assessment criteria and learning outcomes for unit assessment within each unit in Engage.

You can find a full copy of the Online Masters Feedback Policy in your [Programme Hub](#).

Section 3 – Your Course

Educational Aims: MSc Artificial Intelligence

The key educational aim is to equip you with the core knowledge and skillset that is required to undertake a career in AI (across a broad employer base), or to progress into a research role in the field. Delivery is focused on providing the most relevant knowledge in three key areas – scientific foundations, analytic methodology, and software technology.

Learning Outcomes: MSc Artificial Intelligence

Knowledge & Understanding

By the end of the Postgraduate Diploma (PGDip) and Certificate (PGCert)* students will be able to:

- explain the core underlying statistical context that applies to the processing and modelling of data;
- implement low-level data science functionality in a relevant programming language;
- apply a range of modern analytic methodologies, notably machine learning and statistical techniques, using relevant software libraries;
- describe and demonstrate the processes involved in the effective practice of data science and statistics, from initial data handling through to presentation of output.

Graduating **MSc** students will also be able to:

- undertake an individual innovative (research or developmental) project and complete it to a professional standard;
- understand and show critical awareness of the current state and future directions of technological advances.

Intellectual Skills

By the end of the PG Diploma and Certificate* students will:

- demonstrate understanding of essential facts, concepts, principles and theories relating to Artificial Intelligence, and their relationship to one another;
- apply the fundamental concepts and principles of Artificial Intelligence to the solution of engineering and computer science problems in both familiar and in complex and unpredictable professional environments;
- integrate and critically evaluate information and data from a variety of sources in order to gain a coherent understanding of theory and practice;
- demonstrate an ability to engage in a peer review process that involves the critical review of papers, software and proposals, coupled with positive advice for improvement;
- critically analyse and evaluate existing systems and approaches to solving problems.

Graduating **MSc** students will also be able to:

- critically analyse, evaluate and reflect upon own contributions;
- define safe and valid solutions to problems in AI and undertake research and/or development in a particular area of the discipline.

Professional Practical Skills

By the end of the course PG Diploma and Certificate* students will be able to:

- employ a range of established and new techniques to review and critically analyse information concerning theoretical and practical problems in the context of AI, and to propose and implement solutions in a professional manner;

- understand and apply relevant ethical, legal and professional standards including an awareness of relevant regulatory requirements governing professional activities in the context of AI;
- work effectively as part of a team in the analysis, design and development of software-based systems;
- consider alternative models of problems and apply practical and theoretical understanding to select appropriate, possibly innovative, solutions;
- present succinctly rational and reasoned arguments using appropriate conceptual tools to address a given problem;

Graduating **MSc** students will also be able to:

- undertake project work demonstrating a significant degree of individual initiative in both its specification and organisation.

Transferable/Key Skills

By the end of the course PG Diploma and Certificate* students will be able to:

- utilise directed problem solving and analytical skills in a wide variety of practical situations;
- undertake decision making and evaluation in complex situations;
- work effectively as part of a team and appreciate the key roles involved;
- acquire skills and information needed for continuing professional development;
- manage small-medium sized projects with resource and time constraints;
- manage one's own learning and development including time management and organisational skills;
- evaluate systems in terms of general and specific quality attributes and the possible trade-offs within a given problem.

Graduating **MSc** students will also be able to:

- manage a larger software/research project to completion
- undertake critical assessment of their own work

** As all units are at level 7, the differences between PGCert and PGDip are in terms of breadth of knowledge, whilst the differences between the PGDip and the MSc is in the ability to undertake an independent case study/policy evaluation.*

Course Structure

The course is structured with units being delivered sequentially in four phases.

- **Phase 1: Foundations:** This phase focuses on core principles in artificial intelligence including programming, mathematics, and the foundations of artificial intelligence. It provides the essential theoretical and practical knowledge required for advanced study.
- **Phase 2: Core Applications:** In this phase, you will apply the principles learned in Phase 1 to various artificial intelligence applications.
- **Phase 3: Further Applications:** In this phase you will choose from a pool of optional units to further apply your knowledge in new areas of application.
- **Phase 4: Dissertation:** You will undertake an individual research or developmental project, applying your knowledge and skills to a significant piece of work that contributes to the field of artificial intelligence.

The phasing of the units is to give a coherent structure to the course, and students must attempt all units in phase order. Students can progress from one phase to the next carrying failure to the extent permitted under the regulations.

The order of units in the course description ([appendix 1](#)) forms your initial Learning Contract (a form of personal study plan). If you take a study break or suspend studies then the sequence with which you study units subsequently will change and a new Learning Contract (personal study plan) will be agreed with you to document how you might complete the course within the permitted timeframe (see section: [Changes in your Circumstances](#)).

All units have a credit value and the total credits for your course are 180. The credits are called Credit Accumulation Transfer Scheme (CATS), in the UK and are equivalent to 10 notional hours of study per one CATS credit. Phase 1 carries 30 credits, Phase 2 carries 40 credits, phase 3 carries 40 credits and phase 4 carries 70 credits. Notional study hours include engaging with the online material, independent reading and study, and preparing for and taking assessment.

The course does not follow the traditional Academic Year structure. Most units are of 10 CATS credit value and are studied in an eight-week block or term. There are six units delivered in a calendar year meaning 48 weeks study per year, with four non-study weeks. Study breaks are possible (see section: [Changes in your Circumstances](#)).

If you leave the University early, without completing your course, you may be eligible for an exit award. There are stopping-off points at PG Certificate (60 credits) and PG Diploma (120 credits).

Minimum and Maximum Period of Study

The minimum duration of the course is 2 years and 3 months. It is possible to complete the course within this timeframe if you do not take a break and complete your dissertation/project in the shortest possible time. You would however be expected to spend significantly more hours per week on your dissertation/project; for example, completing a 60-credit dissertation/project in 3 months would equate to over 40 hours of study per week.

You may take up to a maximum of 12 months to submit the 60-credit dissertation/project. Regardless of the time taken, the support available to you and the expectations of the dissertation/project remain the same.

The maximum period of study for this course is 5 years; **however, if you are in receipt of a postgraduate loan to fund your studies, you must study at a pace to complete the course in a maximum period of 3 years to remain eligible for loan funding.**

It is anticipated that most students will complete the course within 3 years, unless you need to take a break from your studies (see section: [Changes in your Academic Circumstances](#)).

For students funded by a postgraduate loan, if you take a break from your studies, we are required to report inactivity to the Student Loans Company (SLC) and you will be required to request to suspend your studies. This enables you to take a break and still complete the course within the maximum 3-year duration, and remain eligible for loan funding. You can suspend your studies for a cumulative period of up to a maximum of 12 months.

Appendix 1 Course Description: MSc Artificial Intelligence

Course code	TSCM – VDM0002 MSc Artificial Intelligence
Course title	MSc Artificial Intelligence
Award type	Master of Science
Award title	MSc in Artificial Intelligence
Mode of Attendance	Online
Length	Part time Standard minimum duration: 2 years 3 months Maximum duration: 5 years
State any designated alternative course(s)	<i>Exit awards:</i> PG Certificate PG Diploma
Approving body and date of course approval	Senate 5 February 2020

MSc Artificial Intelligence

(for implementation in 2025/6 academic year)

	Unit code	Unit title	Unit status	Credits	Taught (TSC), or Dissertation/ project (DPC) credits	Notes
Phase 1	CM500324	Principles of Programming for Artificial Intelligence	Core	10	TSC	Units should be taken in the order specified.
	CM500325	Mathematics for Artificial Intelligence	Core	10	TSC	Units should be taken in the order specified.
	CM500326	Foundations of Artificial intelligence	Core	10	TSC	Units should be taken in the order specified.
Phase 2	CM500329	Applications of Artificial Intelligence	Core	10	TSC	Units should be taken in the order specified.
	CM500330	Humans and Intelligent Machines	Core	10	TSC	Units should be taken in the order specified.
	CM500328	Introduction to NLP	Core	10	TSC	Units should be taken in the order specified.
	CM500327	Artificial Intelligence Systems Engineering	Core	10	TSC	Units should be taken in the order specified.
Phase 3*	CM500331	Further Artificial Intelligence	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 1

	CM500336	Reinforcement Learning	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 1
	CM500333	Artificial Intelligence as a Social and Political Practice	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 1
	CM500295	Entrepreneurship	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 1
	CM500360	Deep Learning	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 2
	CM500334	Robotics	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 2
	CM500335	Advanced Deep Learning	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 2
	CM500337	Robotics and Machine Vision	Option	10	TSC	Optional Block 2
Phase 4	CM500338	Research Project Preparation	Core	10	DPC	Must be studied before Dissertation
	CM500339	Dissertation	Core	60	DPC	
				180		

***Optional Choice Rules (Phase 3):**

Select 4 units in total: 2 from Block 1, and 2 from Block 2. Units can be taken in any order.

You can take either Deep Learning or Advanced Deep Learning – you cannot take both units.

You can take either Robotics or Robotics and Machine Vision – you cannot take both units.

To exit with a PG Diploma, select 5 units in total: minimum 2 from Block 1 and minimum 2 from Block

The availability of optional units is subject to constraints such as staff availability, minimum and maximum cohort sizes, and timetabling factors, as well as a student's ability to meet any pre-requisite rules.

Decision references (See section: Assessment Regulations for further information)

NFAAR-PGOLC decisions reference

See **NFAAR-PGOLC** information at: <http://www.bath.ac.uk/corporate-information/assessment-regulations-for-postgraduate-online-courses>

NFAAR-PGOLC, **Appendix 4: PG online study to Master award**